



EUROPEAN EDUCATION AND CULTURE EXECUTIVE AGENCY (EACEA)

EACEA.A – Erasmus+, EU Solidarity Corps
EACEA.A.2 – Skills and Innovation

Capacity Building in the field of VET 2026

Assessment structure

Remember to cover all the guiding points under each award criteria, following the [call document](#). Write a cohesive paragraph per guiding point under each award criterion.

IMPORTANT: PLEASE REMEMBER TO TYPE YOURSELF EACH GUIDING POINT (I.E. "LINK TO OBJECTIVES AND THEMATIC AREAS") IN THE BOXES OF THE 4 AWARD CRITERIA IN THE SAME ORDER OF THE ERASMUS+ PROGRAMME GUIDE 2026

1. Relevance

- **Link to objectives, thematic areas, horizontal aspects and capacity building**
 - the proposal is clear and in line with the objectives and thematic areas and horizontal aspects of the action;
 - in particular, the capacity building activities are clearly defined and aim at realistically reinforcing the capacities, principally of the participating organisations from third countries not associated to the Programme;
- **Regional priorities**
 - the proposal explicitly refers to and addresses the regional priorities, including relevant policy documents listed under this action (for relevant countries)
 - EU Africa Global Gateway investment package
 - EU-Latin America and Caribbean Global Gateway Investment agenda
 - Economic and Investment Plans
 - Torino process country reports
- **EU Values**
 - The proposal is relevant for the respect and promotion of shared EU values, such as respect for human dignity, freedom, democracy, equality, the rule of law and respect for human rights, as well as fighting any sort of discrimination.

2.1 Quality of the project design and implementation

- **Local needs and context**
 - the proposal is based on a strong needs analysis of participating organisations, final beneficiaries and target groups from third countries not associated to the programme and is feasible in their local context(s);
- **Coherence and methodology**
 - the overall project design ensures consistency between project objectives and activities.
 - The proposal presents a coherent and comprehensive set of appropriate activities and services to meet the identified needs and lead to the expected results.
 - There are appropriate phases for preparation, implementation, monitoring, exploitation, evaluation and dissemination;
- **Work plan**
 - the work plan is clear, credible, balanced and qualitative and quantitative indicators are used for activities and deliverables;
- **Selection of participants**

- the quality of arrangements for the selection of participants involved in the proposal activities in relation to inclusion and diversity objectives;
 - **Recognition and validation**
 - the existence and quality of arrangements for the recognition and validation of participants' learning outcomes as well as the consistent use of European transparency and recognition tools (EQF415, EQAVET416, Europass417, ESCO418 and relevant competence frameworks such as DigComp419, EntreComp420, LifeComp421, GreenComp422);
 - **Quality control measures**
 - the existence and relevance of quality control measures to ensure that the project implementation is of high quality, completed in time and on budget;
 - **Cost-effectiveness**
 - the proposal is cost-effective and allocates appropriate resources to each activity;
 - the budget is balanced and takes into account the aim of CB VET projects: to support the relevance, accessibility, and responsiveness of VET institutions.
 - **Mobility activities**
 - the appropriateness of measures for selecting and/or involving participants in mobility activities (please refer to "Protection, health and safety of participants" in part A of this Guide as well to other requirements and recommendations applicable to KA1 Mobility projects) – if applicable, i.e. if mobility activities are part of the application.
 - **Innovation**
 - the proposal considers state-of-the-art methods, techniques and previous similar initiatives already carried out by the participating organisations;
 - it leads to innovative results and solutions for its field in general, or for the geographical context in which the project is implemented.
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2.2 Quality of the partnership and the cooperation arrangements

- **Configuration**
 - the project involves an appropriate mix of complementary participating organisations with the necessary profile, experience and expertise to successfully deliver all aspects of the project.
 - **Commitment**
 - the contribution from the project partners is significant, pertinent and complementary;
 - the proposal demonstrates the partners' involvement, commitment and ownership of the project's specific objectives and results, in particular from the third countries not associated to the Programme.
 - **Coordination and collaboration**
 - the existence of effective mechanisms for coordination, collaboration and communication between the participating organisations, as well as with other relevant stakeholders.
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3. Impact

- **Impact**
 - the potential impact of the project:
 - on participants and participating organisations, during (short term effects) and after the project lifetime (medium and long term effects);

- outside the organisations and individuals directly participating in the project, at local, regional, national and/or international levels;
- are impact indicators sound (specific, measurable, achievable, relevant and time-bound)?
- **Dissemination**
 - the quality of the dissemination plan;
 - the appropriateness and quality of measures aimed at sharing the outcomes of the project within and outside the participating organisations;
- **Exploitation**
 - the proposal demonstrates how the outcomes of the project will be used by the partners and other stakeholders.
 - It describes exploitation measures within project lifetime and after;
- **Open access**
 - the proposal describes how the materials, documents and media produced will be made freely available and promoted through open licences, and without disproportionate limitations;
- **Sustainability**
 - the quality of the plans for ensuring the sustainability of the project;
 - its capacity to continue having an impact and producing results after the EU grant has been used up.
 - Were relevant, how the private sector will be engaged during and after the project funding.

Overall comments

- Evaluation summary (approximately 3 -5 lines + summarize assessment conclusions)
- Strengths (approximately 3 -5 bullet points)
- Weaknesses (approximately 3 -5 bullet points)
- Feedback to the Evaluation Committee:
 - Eligibility checks by experts:
 - Relevant type of organisation as Coordinator and relevant types of organisations for partners to comply with partnership composition = active in VET
 - **At least one VET provider at secondary education level**
 - The activities take place in the countries of the organisations participating in them
 - Completeness: please add if the proposal is over 40 pages, if it uses a different template, if sections are missing.
 - 80% co-financing rate applied

Evaluation tips

- Evaluate each proposal as submitted and not on its potential if certain changes were to be made

- Evaluate the proposal even though the page-limit (40 pages max) has not been respected or if the templates for the Part B and the Detailed Budget table have not been used. In such cases, report it under “Overall Comments”.
- Explain shortcomings, but do not make recommendations
- Do not summarize the proposal while commenting on award criteria. Please avoid describing proposals. Do not quote from the proposal or use inverted commas
- Avoid inconsistency between the score and the comments.
- Avoid contradictory comments in different areas of your assessment.
- If you identify shortcomings that prevent the project from achieving its objectives give a score below threshold.
- Comments on the budget:
 - 1) under the guiding point “Budget” assess whether the resources proposed per WP and per beneficiary are reasonable and consistent with the activities described under the WPs.
 - 2) under the specific Financial comments box if you chose “NO”, provide a comment on the financial shortcomings /inconsistencies and -as appropriate- propose to decrease or to re-shuffle the budget.
- If a project is 24m: projects are eligible and must be evaluated. The duration should be pointed out in the overall comment box.
 - Projects should normally last 36 months. If there is a different duration, this must be clearly explained in the proposal
 - If the proposal does not include a concrete explanation of the different duration, the experts can raise this in the comments
- Experts should consider if the proposal is cost-efficient for the requested budget and proposed duration (if they are requesting the max EU grant for only 2 years instead of 3 it could be a problem).
- Use clear and polite language. Avoid making value judgements or emotional language (do not use: ‘I think’, ‘it seems’, ‘in my opinion’...)
- You should draft all comments in English. Comments must be concise, complete and comprehensible. Avoid vague, ambiguous statements or acronyms. Long sentences are hard to follow.
- The evaluation report should be utilisation-focused (mindful about its usefulness to its intended users), influence- and consequences-aware. Both successful and unsuccessful applicants should be able to draw useful conclusions from the report.
- Proposals are always in SCOPE -so please tick the corresponding box



Quality standard for IERs and CRs

Comments must reflect the assessment of **the criteria in the frame of what is requested in the call**.

Comments should be **precise and definite**.

Avoid **factual mistakes**. Whenever factual statements are made, they should be **explicitly verified**.

Comments should consist of **clear, concise and complete sentences**.

Comments must not be **discriminatory, offending or inappropriate**

Comments must **not be based on assumptions and should not suggest ignorance or doubt**.

Comments must **not contain recommendations or suggestions** to improve the project.

The comment for a criterion, taken as a whole, must be **consistent with the meaning of the score** that is awarded for that criterion.



Other tips and concrete examples to write comments:

Comments should be **precise** and **definite**.

Examples:

✗ "We think the management plan is probably inadequate given the duration of the project and the number of partners."

✓ "The management plan is inadequate. It does not include clear overall responsibility for the training activities; it lacks a problem-solving mechanism in the event of disputes between partners."

✗ "The resources for the project are unrealistic"

✓ "The resources in WP 4 and 6 are underestimated by some 25% given the complexity of the activity proposed."

✗ "Good potential impact can be foreseen."

✓ "The exploitation and dissemination plan addresses well the key target audiences and provides a detailed and well thought out strategy for engaging with them, for example having confirmed presentation slots at national teacher conferences will ensure a significant impact. However, the lack of detail on X is a shortcoming."

- Do not to make categorical statements needlessly and **avoid factual mistakes**. If in doubt, instead of writing "This proposal does not address X", it is advisable to write "This proposal does not significantly [or sufficiently] addresses X".
 - Avoid unnecessary details that could easily be a factual mistake e.g. page numbers, amounts (of whatever kind), project duration, etc.
 - Whenever factual statements are made, they should be explicitly verified.

Example:

✗ "There is no discussion of a dissemination strategy."

✓ "Dissemination activities are listed but the proposal lacks a clear dissemination strategy, in particular activities like X, Y and their interaction are not clearly described and Z was not properly taken into account."

✗ "Concerns are expressed regarding the possibility to achieve the objectives of the project in **three** years." ... and the actual duration was **four** years.

✗ "The proposal provides a clear statement of activities divided among the **three** objectives" ... and there were actually **eight** objectives.

✗ "Late field test (Month 30) does not allow enough time to improve solution."... and the field test was planned in month 24

- Comments should consist of clear, concise and complete sentences.
 - Start from the given vocabulary ("...poor, fair, good, very good, excellent...") and expand from there, using:

Vocabulary for positive comments:

- extremely relevant, credible, very clear, precisely specified, realistic, very innovative, extremely well suited, timely, convincing, comprehensive, high quality, justified, very well identified, strong, highly effective, thoughtful, very promising, evidence, well-formulated, carefully prepared, very professionally prepared, fully in line, very profound, sound, very convincingly integrated, clearly articulated, coherent, well balanced, very plausible, ambitious, clear advances, well above average, ...

Vocabulary for negative comments:

- insufficient, minimal, fails to describe, unacceptable, inadequate, very generic, not evident, unfocused, very weak, bad, does not meet the requirements, inappropriate, limited, unclear, not sound enough, not specified, no significant impact, unjustified, overestimated ...

Examples:

"The proposal has a standard management plan" ... does this mean "up to standard" or "ordinary"?

Comments must not be discriminatory, offending or inappropriate

✗ "There are too many partners from country X in the consortium."

✓ "The project's effort and impact is over-concentrated in one country or region."

✗ "The coordinator is not adequately experienced."

✓ "The coordinator does not demonstrate in the proposal an adequate level of experience in this field."

✗ "The proposal is naïve."

✗ "The overall budget is distributed quite asymmetrically; the coordinating institution is taking close to one third of the entire funding requested."

- The CR comments should not be based on assumptions. If the proposal is unclear on important aspects, the comment(s) and lower score(s) for the applicable criterion/criteria should reflect this. Comments should not suggest ignorance or doubt.

Do not use words like... "Perhaps, Think, Seems, Assume, Probably"

Example:

✗ "We don't understand the relevance of Work package 4 to the goal of the project."

✓ "The proposer has not adequately explained the relevance of Work package 4 to the goals of the project."

Scoring

To be considered for funding, proposals must score at least 60 points (out of 100 points in total), also taking into account the necessary minimum pass score for each of the four award criteria. Furthermore, they must score at least half of the maximum score points for each of the four award criteria mentioned above (i.e. minimum 15 points for the "relevance of the project" and the "quality of the project design and implementation"; 10 points for the "quality of the partnership and the cooperation arrangements" and "impact").

The scoring range depends on the maximum points for each criterion, as illustrated below. Criteria with max 20 points:

- 0 – The proposal fails to address the criterion or cannot be assessed due to missing or incomplete information.

- 1-3 – Poor. The criterion is inadequately addressed, or there are serious inherent weaknesses.
- 4-9 – Fair. The proposal broadly addresses the criterion, but there are significant weaknesses.
- 10-13 – Good. The proposal addresses the criterion well, but a number of shortcomings are present.
- 14-17 – Very Good. The proposal addresses the criterion very well, but a small number of shortcomings are present.
- 18-20 – Excellent. The proposal successfully addresses all relevant aspects of the criterion. Any shortcomings are minor.

Criteria with max 30 points:

- 0 – The proposal fails to address the criterion or cannot be assessed due to missing or incomplete information.
- 1-6 – Poor. The criterion is inadequately addressed, or there are serious inherent weaknesses.
- 7-14 – Fair. The proposal broadly addresses the criterion, but there are significant weaknesses.
- 15-20 – Good. The proposal addresses the criterion well, but a number of shortcomings are present.
- 21-26 – Very Good. The proposal addresses the criterion very well, but a small number of shortcomings are present.
- 27-30 – Excellent. The proposal successfully addresses all relevant aspects of the criterion. Any shortcomings are minor.

Only full marks may be given. No half marks or decimals.